Q15

- The factors that need to be taken into account in measuring the impact on the environment are not always fully understood or agreed [1]
- Areas such as the implications of emissions or the need to manage climate change are often the subject of controversy. That can make it difficult to measure and report on sustainability [1]
- The question of whether an entity can be viewed as managing resources responsibly when it is consuming natural resources that may be irreplaceable is complicated [1]
- This is also an area in which companies may feel exposed because they may be encouraging criticism of their behaviour through admitting to their environmental impact [1]
- For example, attempts to offset carbon emissions are often viewed as inadequate because it may take some time for the offset to actually occur in the face of emissions that are occurring in the short term [1]
- Social and political differences can mean that companies will always face criticisms that their reports are deliberately misleading [1]

[6, Max 5]

Many candidates passed this question as they managed to think of three points that were relevant. Few candidates achieved a high score.